



SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Gulveer Singh sets 5000m indoor national record

Hangzhou Asian Games bronze medallist Gulveer Singh broke the national record and became the first Indian to break the 13-minute barrier in the men's 5000m indoor race at the BU Terrier DMR Challenge in Boston. The 26-year-old Army runner, who already held the national record in 5000m, clocked 12:59.77, finishing fourth in the event behind Cole Hocker (12:57.82), Cooper Teare (12:57.97), and Jack Rayner (12:59.43).

The Indian's performance not only set a new national record but also established a new Asian 5000m short track record. His performance eclipsed the earlier Asian indoor 5000m record of 13:08.41s set by Thailand's Kieran Tuntivate in 2022.

Gulveer's run saw him surpassing the World Athletics Championships qualifying standard of 13:01.00s.

He also bettered his own 5000m outdoor national record of 13:11.82 by more than 12 seconds.

Indian athletics chief coach Radhakrishnan Nair, however, said Gulveer's timing may not be considered as the outdoor national record. "Indoor timing may not be considered as outdoor national record, though Gulveer's indoor timing is better than even the outdoor," Nair said.

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1 Services emerged victorious in a nail-biting final against Railways to claim the 71st senior National men's kabaddi championship at the Jawaharlal Nehru Indoor Stadium in Cuttack. Led by Pro Kabaddi League star Naveen Kumar, Services prevailed 30-30 (6-4) in a tie-breaker, showcasing remarkable composure when it mattered the most. Services' defensive combination of Jaideep Dahiya and Rahul Sethpal — winners of the PKL in season 11 — proved crucial in key moments.

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2 Uttarakhand's Man Singh and Bhagirathi Bisht won the men's and women's titles, respectively, at the Apollo Tyres New Delhi Marathon race. The 35-year-old Singh, the 2024 Asian Marathon Championship winner, clocked an impressive time of 2:15:24s to emerge winner in a competitive men's elite field. Pardeep Chaudhary (2:15:29s) and Akshay Saini (2:15:34s) were right on his heels, but finished second and third, respectively. Bhagirathi, also from Uttarakhand, claimed the top spot among elite women with a time of 02:48:59s. Thakor Bharatjee (02:49:16) and Ashwini Jadhav (02:50:48) won the silver and bronze, respectively.

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